3. Unitary Constitution Great Britain is a unitary state. Hence, all the powers of the Government are vested in a single supreme Central Government. The local governments are created only for administrative convenience and they work under the complete control of the Central Government located at London. They derive their authority from the Central Government which can also abolish them altogether at any time.

4. Parliamentary Government The British Constitution provides for parliamentary form of Government in which the executive hails from the legislature and remains responsible to it. The features of the British Parliamentary system of Government are as follows:

(i) The King or Queen is the nominal executive while the Cabinet is the real executive. The King or Queen is head of the State while the Prime Minister is head of the Government.

(ii) The party which secures majority seats in the House of Commons, forms the government. The leader of that party is appointed as the Prime Minister by the King/Queen.

(iii) The Ministers are individually as well as collectively responsible to the House of Commons for their acts. They remain in office so long as they enjoy the majority support in the House.

(iv) The King or Queen can dissolve the House of Commons on the advise of the Prime Minister.

(v) The Ministers (members of the executive) are also the members of the British Parliament. This avoids conflicts between the executive and the legislature and facilitates better coordination between them.

5. Sovereignty of Parliament Sovereignty means the supreme power within the State. That supreme power in Great Britain lies with the Parliament. Hence, sovereignty of Parliament (or supremacy of Parliament) is a cardinal principle of the British constitutional law and political system. This principle implies the following things:

(i) The British Parliament can make, amend, substitute or repeal any law. De Lolme said, 'The British Parliament can do everything except make a woman a man and a man a woman'.

(ii) The Parliament can make constitutional laws by the same procedure as ordinary laws. In other words, there is no legal distinction between the constituent authority and the law-making authority of the British Parliament.

(iii) The parliamentary laws cannot be declared invalid by the judiciary as being unconstitutional. In other words, there is no system of judicial review in Great Britain.

6. Rule of Law The doctrine of rule of law is one of the fundamental characteristics of the British constitutional system. It lays down that the law is supreme and hence the Government must act according to law and within the limits of the law. A.V. Dicey in his book *The Law of the Constitution* (1885), has given the following three implications of the doctrine of rule of law:

(i) Absence of arbitrary power, that is no man can be punished except for a breach of law.

(ii) Equality before the law, that is, equal subjection of all citizens (rich or poor, high or low, official or non-official) to the ordinary law of the land administered by the ordinary law courts.

(iii) The primacy of the rights of the individual, that is the Constitution is the result of the rights of individual as defined and enforced by the courts of law, rather than the Constitution being the source of